



SPLASH STORE MALTA

THE SCANNING SETUP • JULY 2026

One kit. Everything scanned, nothing forgotten.

A tablet and a professional barcode scanner run the warehouse; your phone records sales on the road. Every product gets scanned in once, then every pick, delivery and payment keeps the shop's stock true — automatically.

THE KIT — ~€1,500 ONCE, ALMOST ALL OF IT BOUGHT IN MALTA

WHAT		WHERE	PRICE
	Samsung Galaxy Tab S10 FE 128 GB The warehouse terminal. Updates to 2032, best battery in its class, water/dust rated — picked to still feel good in 5–7 years.	Malta: Scan Malta — in stock Abroad: idealo.de from €403	€469
	Zebra DS2278 barcode scanner Professional scanner, officially supported by Shopify. Keeps scanning with no internet and syncs later. Ask iLabMalta to add the charging cradle (drop-in charging + wired backup connection).	Malta: iLabMalta — in stock, on sale Abroad (kit incl. cradle): idealo.de €185 · amazon.de	€199
	Spare scanner battery The battery is what wears out first on any cordless scanner — a spare on the shelf keeps the 5–7-year promise.	Malta: iLabMalta — 3 in stock Abroad: amazon.de (.search part no.)	€52
	Zebra ZD230 label printer (thermal transfer) + plastic label rolls & ribbon Prints barcode labels for products that arrive without one — on plastic stock with ribbon ink, because ordinary labels fade in a hot garage within months. Labels and ribbons stocked locally too.	Malta: iLabMalta — in stock (+ labels) Abroad: idealo.de from €242	€350 + ~€60



4G router + data SIM

Internet in the warehouse without depending on Wi-Fi — runs off the mains, and gives every future device a connection too.

Malta: [Scan Malta](#) — in stock, + Epic SIM
Abroad: [amazon.de](#)

€69.90 + €10/mo

Hand trolley, 250 kg

Moves a whole order — chlorine buckets, pool boxes — garage to van in one push.

Malta: [Homemate Malta](#)

€115

Abroad: [Wolcraft via amazon.de](#) ~€90

Rugged hand-strap case + screen protector + belt holster

Tablet becomes a carryable clipboard; scanner rides on the belt so both hands stay free for buckets and boxes. The case is the one item Malta shops don't carry.

Case (no Malta stock): [amazon.de](#) · holster: [amazon.de](#)

~€85

Malta: [screen protector at Scan Malta](#)

Shelf labels, mounts, powerbank

Every shelf gets a code (like G1-A-3) so anything can be found — and counted — fast.

Abroad (no Malta equivalent found): [magnetic label strips](#) · [Anker powerbank](#) €24

~€130

Total, one-off

≈ €1,500

~90% of it comes from three Maltese shops — Scan Malta, iLabMalta (Mosta) and Homemate — with local warranty and no shipping wait. Running costs: SIM ~€10/mo · inventory app ~€10/mo · Shopify POS itself is free. Spending more buys nothing: the €1,000+ gear out there is warehouse-fleet equipment that would only add complexity.

WHAT CHANGES, DAY TO DAY

ORDER COMES IN

The tablet shows the picking list. Scan each item as it goes into the van — the wrong-item mistake disappears.

PAID AT THE DOOR

Cash or Revolut — tap it into Shopify on the phone as that payment type. Stock updates by itself.

NEW STOCK ARRIVES

Scan it in at the warehouse. Products without a barcode get one printed and stuck on.

ALWAYS

The website's stock numbers finally match the garage — so nothing oversells online.

FIVE RULES THAT KEEP IT WORKING

Open the Shopify app before entering the garage.

Opened on mobile data first, it keeps working even in a dead spot and syncs later.

Record every cash/Revolut sale the same day.

Unrecorded sales are the #1 reason shop stock counts drift wrong.

Electronics never sleep in the chlorine garage.

Chlorine vapour corrodes them. Scan in there for minutes; store and charge in the clean garage or at home.

Battery protection on, day one.

Samsung's 80–85% charge cap — tablets that live on chargers in hot rooms die of swollen batteries in ~2 years.

Test before the big scan.

In the first week (while returns are possible): scanner adds items to the Shopify cart, and its offline memory uploads correctly.

One practical note on ordering: everything should be tested together in the first week — scanner to tablet, offline scanning, label printing — while the shops' return windows are still open. Ask iLabMalta to quote the DS2278's charging cradle with the order (drop-in charging plus a wired backup connection).

The chlorine rule (worth repeating)

Chlorine fumes rust and destroy electronics, tools and shelving. Keep chemicals in their own ventilated garage with lids tight; keep the tablet, scanner, printer and chargers in the other garage or at home. This one habit protects the whole kit.

Every item here was chosen by verifying prices and stock live, and by reading real owners' long-term experiences with each device — then stress-testing the choices against the alternatives. Nothing was picked from a spec sheet.

Prepared by Riccardo — July 2026. Prices checked live 9–11 July 2026; re-check at purchase. Full research file with sources available on request.

